

Component 1: Devising

Overview

In this component students will develop their creative and exploratory skills to devise an original performance. The starting point for this devising process will be an extract from a performance text and an influential theatre practitioner.

In their creative explorations, students will learn how text can be manipulated to communicate meaning to audiences and they will begin the process of interpretation. They will gain an understanding of how a new performance could be developed through the practical exploration of the theatrical style and use of conventions of the chosen practitioner.

Content

There are **three** main areas of focus.

- 1) Interpreting, creating and developing a devised piece from **one key extract** from a performance text and applying the methods of **one** practitioner.
- 2) A performance/design realisation of the devised piece.
- 3) Analysing and evaluating the creative process for a devised performance.

Students may complete this component as part of a duologue performance (2 performers) or a group performance (3 – 6 performers).NB: The duologue performance option will be for first teaching September 2025, first assessment 2027.

Students may complete this component either as a performer or as a designer.

The design roles are:

- costume design
- lighting design
- set design
- sound design.

Centres wanting to offer design roles to students should refer to *Appendix 3: Design roles minimum resource guidance requirements for centres*.

Choice of text

Centres have a free choice when selecting the **one key extract** from a performance text. However they must take the following into consideration when choosing the text.

- Be professionally published and substantial, and have a running time of 60 minutes minimum.
- Offer students the opportunity to demonstrate exploratory range and depth that is appropriate to the level of demand for A level study.
- Offer students the opportunity to access the demands of this component as a performer and/or designer.
- Have the degree of challenge, in terms of appropriateness of content, language, complexity of themes, and access to deeper social, historical and cultural contexts to enable students to achieve at A level and meet the Assessment Objectives.
- Cannot be any prescribed text from the Component 3 list.

- Must be different from the text studied in Component 3 so that students study a range of performance texts. This means it must differ in at least one of the following ways:
 - o time period
 - o theatrical convention
 - o thematic content, form or structure
 - o playwright
 - o social, historical and cultural contexts.

For the purposes of this qualification, a **key extract** is defined as a scene or a moment that is significant to the text as a whole and at least 10 minutes in length when performed.

Centres should consider the skills, experience and prior learning of students in choosing text that will engage their interest throughout the considerable preparation and rehearsal time needed for this component.

Choice of practitioner

Centres have a free choice when selecting a practitioner. For the purposes of this qualification, a practitioner is an individual or a company that has an established and defined approach to the creation of performance, and which creates both theatrical performances and theory that informs this practical work. As with the text choice, the choice of practitioner must:

- be chosen so it offers students the opportunity to demonstrate exploratory range and depth to is appropriate to the level of demand for A level study
- offer students the opportunity to access the demands of this component as a performer and/or designer
- have the degree of challenge, in terms of appropriateness of content, language, complexity of themes, access to deeper social, historical and cultural contexts to enable students to achieve at A level and meet the Assessment Objectives.

The choice of practitioner must not be the same as the one chosen in Component 3. However, centres are free to use any of the other practitioners in the Component 3 list for use in Component 1, or centres can choose a different practitioner, for example Katie Mitchell, Frantic Assembly, Grotowski or Forced Entertainment.

Centres are reminded that they must complete the online form regarding text and practitioner choices, please refer to *page 7* for details.

Duologue / Group Requirements

Duologue time limits

A duologue must contain 2 performance students. In addition, there can be up to one designer per role, per duologue.

All students must be assessed as individuals.

The regulatory requirements are that duologues must complete a minimum performance time of 5 minutes for this component.

The recommended minimum performance times have been provided to ensure that each student within the duologue has sufficient time to access all levels of the assessment criteria.

Group sizes and time limits

Students must work in a group. Groups must have between **three** and **six** performance students. In addition, there can be up to one designer per role, per group.

All students must be assessed as individuals.

The regulatory requirements are that groups must complete a minimum performance time of 6 minutes for this component.

The recommended minimum performance times have been provided to ensure that each student within the group has sufficient time to evidence their skills for this component.

Group size	Recommended minimum performance times	Maximum performance times
2 performance students (duologue)	10 minutes	12 minutes
3–4 performance students	15 minutes	20 minutes
5–6 performance students	20 minutes	30 minutes

Centres should be aware that performance times that are between the regulatory minimum (6 minutes) and the recommended minimums (15 or 20 minutes) may not allow students to evidence their skills fully in order to access all levels of the assessment criteria.

Meeting the performance timings

Students (performance and design) who do not meet the regulatory minimum performance requirement of 6 minutes will be assessed by teachers against the assessment criteria on *pages 27, 29, 31 and 32*; however students will not be able to achieve beyond Level 2.

Teachers will be required to stop marking after the maximum performance time has passed.

Failure to accurately record the performance times on the authentication sheet (see *Appendix 1*) may result in staff/centre malpractice. For further information about this, please see the *Administration and general information* section in this specification.

1) Devising: interpreting, creating and developing from a complete text and applying the methods of a practitioner

Devising from text is not a re-interpretation of the original text performed in a different style, genre or time period/setting. It must be completely original work which uses the one key extract as a source for ideas only.

Students should undertake exploration of one key extract from a performance text where they interpret, create and develop ideas with the aim of devising an original piece for performance. This exploration should involve placing the key extract in the context of the whole text and also an investigation of one practitioner, in order to apply their methods to the devised piece. There are no limits to the scope of the interpretation. However, students must be given opportunities to know and understand how a specific interpretative process can be developed from given sources and how key elements of a performance text and practitioner methodology can remain a part of the creative process of devising. They must also explore the theatrical practices and processes involved in interpreting a text.

Students should be given the opportunity to devise in a collaborative context, so that they establish an ensemble where ideas and methods are shared and developed. Although the starting point for this work is given, students can build in other stimuli and other practitioners as appropriate.

Before starting their own process of interpreting and devising, students should take part in teacher-led workshops and classes that define the elements of interpretive work on text and practice, including:

- deconstruction of text: analysis of themes, content, structure
- key scenes or turning points in the narrative
- relationship with audience; the nature of the communication
- style of the text and how it fits into a wider genre
- character and characterisation.

Students must develop a range of practical techniques and skills needed to develop and realise the devised performance. The devised performance could incorporate one or more of the following elements of the key extract:

- form
- structure
- character(s)
- dialogue
- themes/issues and ideas.

The influence of the **chosen practitioner** must be evident in the devised performance and this can be shown through application of their methodologies, approaches, theatrical style and/or use of conventions. These could incorporate one or more of the following elements:

- imitate or emulate the performance style and/or use of theatrical conventions of the practitioner
- implement the working methodology/methodologies (evidenced through the portfolio and the performance)
- adapting the text to match the philosophy of the practitioner's performance style and/or use of theatrical conventions
- show some key moments from a practitioner's oeuvre in the performance.

Workshops and classes need to give students the opportunity to build these skills and techniques. These workshops could explore the work of companies, practitioners and individual artists who specialise in devising new work and then apply these ways of working to the stimulus.

Knowledge and understanding

Students must acquire, develop and apply knowledge and understanding to be able to:

- apply research to inform practical work by organising and researching topics, presenting findings, finding narratives and stories, photographs and films that illustrate the themes and ideas
- select key aspects of their research to be put into their original piece
- deconstruct the dramatic elements that make up a performance text
- explore how meaning in performance texts can be informed by social, historical and cultural contexts
- isolate specific themes and ideas, deciding what themes are to be emphasised
- connect their own experiences of live theatre to their own practice and decisions, applying relevant depth of research, independent thought and analysis
- select an appropriate style and genre, possibly connected to the chosen practitioner
- understand the impact they want to have on an audience by the form and style they are using
- shape the drama giving considerations to pace, tempo, order of scenes, finished scripts, desired impact on audience, alternative theatre spaces.

Also students must know how **performance texts** are constructed to conveying meaning through:

- style, structure, language and stage directions
- character construction and interpretation
- use of performance space and spatial relationships on stage
- relationships between performers and audience
- use of design elements.

In addition to this for the **practitioner**, students must acquire, develop and apply knowledge and understanding to be able to:

- know how a practice developed in a different social, historical and cultural context can be understood and adapted to a contemporary age and audience
- make detailed connections between theory and practice in a range of periods, theatrical styles, social, historical and cultural contexts
- recognise and apply the practitioner methodology to their own work.

They must acquire knowledge and understanding of how their **chosen practitioner** has used the following to convey meaning through:

- the social and historical contexts that shaped the theatre practice
- the ideas, theatrical purpose, practice and working methodologies underpinning their work
- the realisation of their artistic intention
- the use of theatrical style and use of conventions
- collaboration with and influence on other practitioners
- how the relationship with audiences is defined in theory and then carried out in practice.

Devising skills

The processes outlined above will equip students with appropriate devising skills. These skills can be summarised as being able to help realise artistic intention through:

- deconstructing ideas, themes and narratives that make up the stimuli
- developing methods that interpret the stimuli, being able to *reposition* it and see it differently
- carrying out in-depth research to inform and develop ideas and creativity
- giving and responding to ideas in a collaborative context.

Students can develop their exploratory skills through:

- workshops
- rehearsal
- taught classes
- individual research
- watching live theatre.

2) The group / duologue devised performance/design realisation

At the culmination of their interpreting, creating and developing process, students must perform their devised piece or realise a design during the performance (please see the design roles section below for more information relating to designers). The rehearsal process should be teacher-led and the performance should take place in front of an appropriate audience.

Centres are free to identify the audience and venue for the performance, this could include:

- performance to the rest of the class or another class within the centre
- performance to an invited external audience.

Performers must acquire, develop and apply the following skills:

- refining and amending work in progress with the aim to realising their artistic intentions
- rehearsing and learning lines
- characterisation through:
 - vocal expression: use of clarity, pace, inflection, pitch and projection
 - physicality: use of space, gesture, stillness and stance
- contact, relationships and communication with other performers on stage (proxemics)
- communication and engagement with the audience.

Students must be supervised when developing these processes. Teachers should adopt a facilitating role for the devised performance(s) but they are **not** allowed to direct performance(s). They can give guidance during the practical work and the preparation for the performance(s) but not during the performance(s).

When in a facilitating role, teachers are **allowed** to:

- help students with interpreting assessment information, e.g. explaining the assessment criteria and the requirements of the component
- intervene if a health and safety issue arises
- intervene if a risk to security of evidence arises
- undertake a management role in relation to managing time, space, resources
- ask questions to stimulate independent thought without leading students.

When in a facilitating role, teachers are **not allowed** to:

- offer coaching
- direct students
- undertake an artistic/creative role
- give solutions to artistic/creative problems
- make artistic/creative decisions.

Students should take into consideration any health and safety implications as appropriate.

3) Analysis and evaluation the creative process and devised performance

All students must acquire and apply the ability to analyse and evaluate the process of creating and developing their own live theatrical work and the effectiveness of the outcome. Students must analyse and evaluate:

- ideas explored and research undertaken
- decisions made and the rationale behind them
- their collaborative involvement
- content, genre, structure, character, form, style, and language
- the final performance and the effectiveness of their contribution to it
- the realisation of their intentions.

All students must also know and understand, and be able to use appropriate subject-specific terminology in their analysis and evaluation.

Design roles

Designers are expected to work collaboratively with performers within their chosen area of design.

Where a student is assessed in the role of a designer, it is their design skill that is the focus of the assessment, rather than their technical competence in the operation or use of

equipment. Designs elements should be suitably theatrical and work in sympathy with other design features (if appropriate). Designs should also take into consideration actor/audience relationships and health and safety implications as appropriate.

Designers will be expected to produce evidence for the portfolio of their design skills that reflect the context of the selected elements of the text and the methods of the influential theatre practitioner; these skills will be applied in the devised performance.

There is a maximum of one designer per role, per group/duologue.

Designers must also acquire, develop and apply the following skills:

- work collaboratively within the devising ensemble
- make appropriate judgements during the devising process
- develop and articulate a design concept
- make appropriate design choices within the context of a performance to an audience
- use and apply design skills to contribute to the performance as a whole
- demonstrate the ability to apply design skills and materials effectively in the context of a performance to an audience.

A list of the requirements for each design skill for this component is given on the next page.

Component 1 – requirements for design skills				
Requirements	Costume design	Lighting design	Set design	Sound design
Design skills	Final costume designs for three different characters, incorporating hair, makeup and mask considerations as appropriate. All sourcing must be based wholly on the student's design(s).	Final lighting design incorporating grid plans and a lantern schedule that indicates the use of five different lighting states.	A 1:25 scale model of the final design to be realised in the performance space and any props as appropriate.	A source sheet showing five sound effects – original, live or found sound effects as appropriate.
Additional documentation	A costume plot or list of costumes/accessories worn by each actor indicating any changes as appropriate.	A lighting plot or cue sheet incorporating a range of transitional devices as appropriate.	A ground plan of the performance space to scale, including entrances and exits, audience positioning and stage furniture (as appropriate).	A cue sheet showing the source, order, length and output level of each cue.
Supervision	The student must supervise the construction, purchasing, dyeing altering, hiring and/or finding of the designed costumes as appropriate.	The student must supervise the rigging, focusing, programming (if applicable) and operating of the design as appropriate.	The student must supervise the construction, painting, hiring and /or finding of scenic elements required to meet the requirements of their design as appropriate.	The student must supervise the operation of the sound as appropriate but need not operate the sound themselves.
Performance	A realisation of the costume design in the performance.	A realisation of the lighting design in the performance.	A realisation of the set design in the performance.	A realisation of the sound design in the performance.

NB: Centres are reminded that any appropriate evidence produced in line with the requirements above should also be sent to the moderator as part of the design students' portfolio.

Assessment information

This component is internally assessed and externally moderated. It is worth 80 marks and AO1, AO2 and AO4 are assessed.

First assessment: 2018

There are **two** parts to the assessment.

- 1) A portfolio containing evidence of:
 - o interpreting, creating and developing a devised piece from one key extract from a performance text and applying the methods of a practitioner (AO1)
 - o analysing and evaluating the creative process and the devised performance (AO4).
- 2) A recording of the group/duologue devised performance (AO2).

The portfolio

All students must produce a portfolio documenting and reflecting on their exploratory process and the skills and techniques that they have developed in response to the text, and the influence of their chosen theatre practitioner.

The portfolio is worth 60 marks. AO1 and AO4 are assessed – AO1 is worth 40 marks and AO4 is worth 20 marks.

The portfolio is marked by the teacher and sent to the moderator if requested as part of the sample, along with the accompanying performance recording.

The portfolio must be the student's own work.

Each portfolio **must** cover the following:

- an exploration of the chosen text and practitioner
- an analysis and evaluation of the student's contribution to the devising process through their ability to create and develop ideas as theatre makers
- an analysis and evaluation of the student's ability to make connections between the chosen text/practitioner and their intended aims and objectives
- an understanding of social, historical and cultural contexts.

Each student **must** include responses to the following statements:

- outline your initial response to the key extract and practitioner and track how it was developed throughout the devising process
- connect your research material/s to key stages in the development process and to performance outcomes
- evaluate how your chosen role/s emerged and developed from initial ideas through to the final performance
- analyse how your contribution was influenced by the selected theatre practitioner and/or theatre makers, and the impact live theatre has had on your own practical work
- discuss how social, historical and cultural context has impacted on your work
- evaluate the creative choices you made and whether or not they were successful in performance.

Portfolios may include any of the following elements:

- annotations and notes
- audio and/or video evidence
- annotated drawings and sketches
- annotated photographs
- extended written responses.

It is recommended that the portfolio be submitted as:

- handwritten/typed evidence between 2500 and 3000 words

or

- recorded/verbal evidence between 12 and 14 minutes

or

- a combination of handwritten/typed evidence (between 1250 and 1500 words) and recorded/verbal evidence (between 6 and 7 minutes).

It is strongly advised that the upper word/time limits are adhered to by students to enable them to satisfy the requirement to produce a concise and coherently structured portfolio.

When students are working on producing their portfolio teachers must follow these rules:

- students must be directly supervised for a sufficient portion of the creation of the portfolio to allow teachers to confidently authenticate each student's work
- teachers should not write any part of a student's portfolio
- teachers may help students to understand the assessment requirements and the assessment criteria
- teachers can provide feedback **once on one draft version** for the portfolio before it is handed in to be marked
- the focus of this feedback must only be on the requirements of the portfolio and the Assessment Objectives
- any additional feedback must be recorded on the *Non-examination assessment authentication sheet* (please see *Appendix 1*).

The devised performance/realisation of design

The devised performance is marked by the teacher and this performance must be recorded unedited. Please refer to *Appendix 4: Best practice when recording performance*. This recorded evidence must be sent to the moderator if requested as part of the sample along with the accompanying portfolios.

The performance/design realisation is worth 20 marks. AO2 is assessed.

A realisation of each design candidate's work must be seen and assessed in the performance.

Teachers must not give support and guidance during the performance.

Performers will be assessed on their ability to realise artistic intentions through their:

- use of vocal and physical skills
- use of characterisation and communication.

Designers will be assessed on their ability to realise artistic intentions through their:

- use of design skills
- understanding of communication and context.

Non-assessed individuals

Non-assessed individuals should be used **only** when:

- the total number of students in the cohort does not meet the minimum size requirement
- a student has withdrawn from the performance near to the assessment date
- a student is absent on the day of the assessment.

Non-assessed individuals may be used to read out the lines of the absent student(s) to support the performance group/duologue. Please note that a non-assessed individual may be a class peer, student from a different year group or a member of staff. Assessed and non-assessed individuals must be clearly identified at the start of the recorded evidence to aid moderation.

Permission must be sought from Pearson in advance for the inclusion of non-assessed individuals. Please email your requests to drama.assessment@pearson.com. A copy of the email from Drama Assessment must be included with the work sent to the moderator.

Resources

Students must have equal access to IT resources and other equipment, as appropriate. Students should have access to a range of resources to enable them to make choices as required for their tasks.

Authenticity

Students and teachers must sign the *Non-examination assessment authentication sheet* (please see *Appendix 1*). All sources must be acknowledged.

Marking, standardisation and moderation

Teachers should mark this component using the assessment criteria on the following pages. Teachers may annotate students' work but should also include any comments on the *Appendix 1: Non-examination assessment authentication sheet* to justify the marks awarded. Any annotations made by the teacher are to be left on the portfolio.

Where marking has been carried out by more than one teacher in a centre, there must be a process of internal standardisation carried out to ensure that there is a consistent application of the assessment criteria.

Marks awarded by the centre will be subject to external moderation by Pearson. Moderation will ensure consistency with national standards and will include a review of assignments to ensure that the assignment-setting rules have been correctly applied by centres. Pearson will notify centres of the students whose work has been selected for moderation. This sample will take cohort size into account. Detailed instructions will be made available for teacher-assessed non-examination assessment and this will include instructions regarding:

- internal standardisation
- materials required for submission (such as timesheets and authentication forms, or additional design skills documentation submitted as part of the design students' portfolio)
- the required sample of candidates (the highest and lowest scoring candidates and a range in between).

In addition to this, centre marking training will be organised by Pearson and will include training on the administrative requirements and best practice.

Moderators of non-examination assessment components will be trained in the administrative arrangements that are required of centres and will be instructed to inform Pearson of any maladministration or malpractice concerns during the process of moderation.

If the moderation indicates that centre assessment does not reflect national standards, an adjustment will be made to students' final marks to compensate.

For further information refer to the Joint Council for Qualifications (JCQ) document *Instructions for conducting non-examination assessments (new GCE and GCSE specifications)* on the JCQ website: www.jcq.org.uk. The assessment of this qualification must comply with these instructions.

Consortium arrangements

If you are a centre that will be part of a consortium, your students will be treated as a single group for the purposes of non-examination assessment moderation.

You need to identify a consortium co-ordinator who must ensure that internal standardisation is carried out by all the teachers involved in each component.

We will allocate the same moderator to every centre within the consortium for a particular component, with confirmation or adjustment of marks being applied to all centres within the consortium.

Centres must register their consortium arrangements using the JCQ centre consortium form available at www.jcq.org.uk/exams-office/forms/centre-consortium-arrangements-form which then must be sent to Pearson.

Non-examination Assessment criteria

Teachers must mark students' work using the assessment criteria on the following pages.

Marking guidance

- All students must receive the same treatment. Teachers must mark the last student in exactly the same way as they mark the first.
- The assessment criteria should be applied positively. Students must be rewarded for what they have shown they can do rather than be penalised for omissions.
- All the marks on the assessment criteria are designed to be awarded. Teachers should always award full marks if deserved, i.e. if the work matches the assessment criteria. Teachers should be prepared to award zero marks if the student's work is not worthy of credit according to the assessment criteria.

Placing a mark within a level

- Teachers should first decide which descriptor most closely matches the work and place it in that level. The mark awarded within the level will be decided based on the quality of the work and will be modified according to how securely all bullet points are displayed at that level.
- In cases of uneven performance, the points above will still apply. Students will be placed in the level that best describes their work according to the descriptors in that level.
- If work meets the requirements fully, markers should be prepared to award full marks within the level. The top mark in the level is used for work that is as good as can realistically be expected within that level.
- If work only barely meets the requirements of the level, markers should consider awarding marks at the bottom of the level. The bottom mark in the level is used for work that is the weakest that can be expected within that level.
- The middle marks of the level are used for work that is a reasonable match to the descriptor. This might represent a balance between some characteristics of the level that are fully met and others that are only barely met.

Assessment criteria for portfolio

Level	Mark	Descriptor (AO1): Creating and developing ideas to communicate meaning as part of theatre-making process (portfolio)
	0	No rewardable material
Level 1	1–4	Limited - Limited reference to relevant research, contexts and live theatre, resulting in superficial decision making. - Basic depth and range of research undertaken and contexts explored. - Superficial understanding of how aims and intentions are created through the devising process, demonstrated through limited development of independent ideas. Basic understanding of the key extract placed in the context of the whole performance text.
Level 2	5–8	General - Generally sound reference to relevant research, contexts and live theatre used to inform appropriate decision making. - Adequate depth and range of research undertaken and contexts explored. - Generally sound understanding of how aims and intentions are created through the devising process, demonstrated through emerging development of independent ideas. Adequate understanding of the key extract placed in the context of the whole performance text.
Level 3	9–12	Competent - Secure reference to relevant research, contexts and live theatre used to inform competent decision making. - Consistent depth and range of research undertaken and contexts explored. - Competent understanding of how aims and intentions are created through the devising process, demonstrated through consistent development of independent ideas. Secure understanding of the key extract placed in the context of the whole performance text.
Level 4	13–16	Assured - Assured reference to relevant research, contexts and live theatre used to inform effective decision making. - Comprehensive depth and range of research undertaken and contexts explored. - Confident understanding of how aims and intentions are created through the devising process, demonstrated through assured development of independent ideas. Assured understanding of the key extract placed in the context of the whole performance text.

Level	Mark	Descriptor (AO1): Creating and developing ideas to communicate meaning as part of theatre-making process (portfolio)
Level 5	17–20	Sophisticated • Accomplished reference to relevant research, contexts and live theatre used to inform perceptive decision making. • Sophisticated depth and range of research undertaken and contexts explored. • Perceptive understanding of how aims and intentions are created through the devising process, demonstrated through sophisticated development of independent ideas. Perceptive understanding of the key extract placed in the context of the whole performance text.

Level	Mark	Descriptor (AO1): Making connections between dramatic theory and practice (portfolio)
	0	No rewardable material
Level 1	1–4	Limited • Superficial knowledge and understanding of the work and methodologies of the chosen practitioner. Makes superficial connections when applying practitioner’s methodologies to own practice. • Basic ability to refine and amend work through the development process in order to realise creative intentions. • Use of subject terminology is limited and/or inaccurate.
Level 2	5–8	General • Reasonably sound knowledge and understanding of the work and methodologies of the chosen practitioner. Makes generally appropriate connections when applying practitioner’s methodologies to own practice. • Emerging ability to refine and amend work through the development process in order to realise creative intentions. • Use of subject terminology is generally accurate.
Level 3	9–12	Competent • Secure knowledge and understanding of the work and methodologies of the chosen practitioner. Competent connections made when applying practitioner’s methodologies to own practice. • Consistent ability to refine and amend work through the development process in order to realise creative intentions. • Use of subject terminology is competent and accurate.
Level 4	13–16	Assured • Confident knowledge and understanding of the work and methodologies of the chosen practitioner. Makes assured connections when applying practitioner’s methodologies to own practice. • Comprehensive ability to refine and amend work through the development process in order to realise creative intentions. • Use of subject terminology is assured.
Level 5	17–20	Sophisticated • Sophisticated knowledge and understanding of the work and methodologies of the chosen practitioner. Makes perceptive connections when applying practitioner’s methodologies to own practice. • Perceptive ability to refine and amend work through the development process in order to realise creative intentions. • Use of subject terminology is accomplished.

Marking instructions

In AO4, analysis is required in order to reach evaluative judgements and conclusions in the context of student's own work.

Evidence presented should show a *balanced consideration* between analysis and evaluation, and marks are equally distributed across these two elements.

Responses that demonstrate isolated analysis without leading to evaluation can only achieve a maximum of 4 marks.

Level	Mark	Descriptor (AO4): Analysing and evaluating their own work (portfolio)
	0	No rewardable material
Level 1	1–4	Limited • Superficial analysis of their personal contribution to the process of exploring and realising artistic intentions, application of performance/design skills to create impact on an audience and collaboration with other theatre makers. • Struggles to offer evaluation demonstrating limited ability to formulate and justify personal judgements of how ideas, meaning and impact are created through application of skills and collaboration. • Uneven treatment of analysis and evaluation resulting in a limited overall response.
Level 2	5–8	General • Clear analysis of their personal contribution to the process of exploring and realising artistic intentions, application of performance/design skills to create impact on an audience and collaboration with other theatre makers. • Offers partial evaluation demonstrating emerging ability to formulate and justify personal judgements of how ideas, meaning and impact are created through application of skills and collaboration. • Partially balanced treatment of analysis and evaluation resulting in a clear overall response.
Level 3	9–12	Competent • Competent analysis of their personal contribution to the process of exploring and realising artistic intentions, application of performance/design skills to create impact on an audience and collaboration with other theatre makers. • Offers consistent evaluation demonstrating competent ability to formulate and justify personal judgements of how ideas, meaning and impact are created through application of skills and collaboration. • Mostly balanced treatment of analysis and evaluation resulting in a competent overall response.

Level	Mark	Descriptor (A04): Analysing and evaluating their own work (portfolio)
Level 4	13–16	Assured - Assured analysis of their personal contribution to the process of exploring and realising artistic intentions, application of performance/design skills to create impact on an audience and collaboration with other theatre makers. - Comprehensive evaluation demonstrating assured ability to formulate and justify personal judgements of how ideas, meaning and impact are created through application of skills and collaboration. - Balanced treatment of analysis and evaluation resulting in an effective overall response.
Level 5	17–20	Sophisticated - Accomplished analysis of their personal contribution to the process of exploring and realising artistic intentions, application of performance/design skills to create impact on an audience and collaboration with other theatre makers. - Perceptive evaluation demonstrating sophisticated ability to formulate and justify personal judgements of how ideas, meaning and impact are created through application of skills and collaboration - Fully balanced treatment of analysis and evaluation resulting in a secure overall response.

Assessment criteria for devised performance: performers

Level	Mark	Descriptor (AO2): Group/duologue performance – vocal and physical skills (performers)
	0	No rewardable material
Level 1	1–2	Limited - Performance is often inappropriate or inconsistent, showing a lack of variety, range and control, with superficial understanding of how creative choices communicate meaning to the audience. - Basic technical control in the use of vocal techniques (clarity, pace, inflection, pitch, projection). - Limited technical control in the use of physical techniques and proxemics (gesture, stillness, stance, contact, use of space and spatial relationships).
Level 2	3–4	General - Performance is generally appropriate and consistent, showing emerging variety, range and control, with generally appropriate understanding of how creative choices communicate meaning to the audience. - Generally sound technical control in the use of vocal techniques (clarity, pace, inflection, pitch, projection). - Generally sound technical control in the use of physical techniques and proxemics (gesture, stillness, stance, contact, use of space and spatial relationships). Any performance under the regulatory minimum performance time cannot progress beyond the top of Level 2.
Level 3	5–6	Competent - Performance is appropriate and consistent, showing clear variety, range and control, with competent understanding of how creative choices communicate meaning to the audience. - Competent technical control in the use of vocal techniques (clarity, pace, inflection, pitch, projection). - Competent technical control in the use of physical techniques and proxemics (gesture, stillness, stance, contact, use of space and spatial relationships).
Level 4	7–8	Assured - Performance is pertinent and comprehensive, showing effective variety, range and control throughout, with secure understanding of how creative choices communicate meaning to the audience. - Assured technical control in the use of vocal techniques (clarity, pace, inflection, pitch, projection). - Assured technical control in the use of physical techniques and proxemics (gesture, stillness, stance, contact, use of space and spatial relationships).

Level	Mark	Descriptor (AO2): Group/duologue performance – vocal and physical skills (performers)
Level 5	9–10	Sophisticated • Performance is perceptively integrated, sophisticated and dynamic, showing skilful variety, range and control throughout, with an accomplished understanding of how creative choices communicate meaning to the audience. • Accomplished technical control in the use of vocal techniques (clarity, pace, inflection, pitch, projection). • Sophisticated technical control in the use of physical techniques and proxemics (gesture, stillness, stance, contact, use of space and spatial relationships).

Level	Mark	Descriptor (A02): Group/duologue performance – use of characterisation and communication to realise artistic intentions (performers)
	0	No rewardable material
Level 1	1–2	Limited • Characterisation demonstrates a basic understanding of the role(s) and practitioner methodologies. Performance has limited credibility and consistency. • Superficial rapport and inconsistent communication with audience/other performers, shown through lack of ease and awareness. • Basic contribution to the performance as a whole and realisation of the group/duologue artistic intentions. Performance overall has limited impact and lacks energy and commitment.
Level 2	3–4	General • Characterisation demonstrates a generally sound understanding of the role(s) and practitioner methodologies. Performance has some credibility and consistency. • Generally sound rapport and communication with audience/other performers, shown through emerging ease and awareness. • Generally sound contribution to the performance as a whole and realisation of the group/duologue artistic intention. Performance overall has emerging impact through some sound energy and commitment. Any performance under the regulatory minimum performance time cannot progress beyond the top of Level 2.
Level 3	5–6	Competent • Characterisation demonstrates a competent understanding of the role(s) and practitioner methodologies. Performance has clear credibility and consistency. • Clear rapport and communication with audience/other performers, shown through secure ease and awareness. • Competent contribution to the performance as a whole and realisation of the group/duologue artistic. Performance overall has clear impact through consistent energy and commitment.
Level 4	7–8	Assured • Characterisation demonstrates an assured understanding of the role(s) and practitioner methodologies. Performance has secure credibility and consistency. • Effective rapport and assured communication with audience/other performers, shown through assured ease and awareness throughout. • Assured contribution to the performance as a whole and realisation of the group/duologue artistic intention. Performance overall has effective impact through comprehensive energy and commitment.

Level	Mark	Descriptor (A02): Group performance – use of characterisation and communication to realise artistic intentions (performers)
Level 5	9–10	Sophisticated • Characterisation demonstrates a perceptive understanding of the role(s) and practitioner methodologies. Performance has accomplished credibility and consistency. • Accomplished rapport and sophisticated communication with audience/other performers, shown through highly-effective ease and awareness. • Accomplished contribution to the realisation of the performance as a whole and group/duologue artistic intention. Performance overall is dynamic and skilfully creates impact through highly-engaging energy and commitment.

Assessment criteria for devised performance: designers

Level	Mark	Descriptor (AO2): Group/duologue performance – design skills (designers)
	0	No rewardable material
Level 1	1–2	Limited - Creates a basic design, demonstrating limited ability to apply design skills. Design is inappropriate and/or unsympathetic to the devised work. - Design shows basic consideration of the practical application of materials and production elements in performance. - Superficial ability to design effectively within time and resource constraints.
Level 2	3–4	General - Creates a generally appropriate design, demonstrating emerging ability to apply design skills. Design is generally appropriate and/or sympathetic to the devised work. - Design shows generally sound consideration of the practical application of materials and production elements in performance. - Emerging ability to design effectively within time and resource constraints. Any design realisation under the regulatory minimum performance time cannot progress beyond the top of Level 2.
Level 3	5–6	Competent - Creates a clear design, demonstrating secure ability to apply design skills. Design is clearly appropriate and/or sympathetic to the devised work. - Design shows consistent consideration of the practical application of materials and production elements in performance. - Competent ability to design effectively within time and resource constraints.
Level 4	7–8	Assured - Creates an effective design, demonstrating secure ability to apply design skills. Design is pertinent and fully sympathetic to the devised work. - Design shows assured consideration of the practical application of materials and production elements in performance. - Comprehensive ability to design effectively within time and resource constraints.
Level 5	9–10	Sophisticated - Creates an engaging design demonstrating accomplished ability to apply design skills. Design perceptively integrates with the devised work in an innovative way. - Design shows perceptive consideration of the practical application of materials and production elements in performance. - Accomplished ability to design effectively within time and resource constraints.

Level	Mark	Descriptor (A02): Group/duologue performance – communication, context and realisation of artistic intention (designers)
	0	No rewardable material
Level 1	1–2	Limited • Design shows a limited understanding of how creative choices create impact and communicate meaning to the audience. • Design shows a superficial understanding of its function and purpose within the performance. • Limited ability to develop a design that supports the creative intent of the performance as a whole. Design overall has limited impact, showing a lack of engagement and commitment to the performance.
Level 2	3–4	General • Design shows an emerging understanding of how creative choices create impact and communicate meaning to the audience. • Design shows a generally sound understanding of its function and purpose within the performance. • Generally sound ability to develop a design that supports the creative intent of the performance as a whole. Design overall has emerging impact, showing some sound engagement and commitment to the performance. Any design realisation under the regulatory minimum performance time cannot progress beyond the top of Level 2.
Level 3	5–6	Competent • Design shows a secure understanding of how creative choices create impact and communicate meaning to the audience. • Design shows competent understanding of its function and purpose within the performance. • Consistent ability to develop a design that supports the creative intent of the performance as a whole. Design overall has clear impact, showing consistent engagement and commitment to the performance.
Level 4	7–8	Assured • Design shows an effective understanding of how creative choices create impact and communicate meaning to the audience. • Design shows an assured understanding of its function and purpose within the performance. • Comprehensive ability to develop a design that supports the creative intent of the performance as a whole. Design overall has effective impact, showing comprehensive engagement and commitment to the performance.

Level	Mark	Descriptor (A02): Group/duologue performance – communication, context and realisation of artistic intention (designers)
Level 5	9–10	Sophisticated • Design shows a sophisticated understanding of how creative choices create impact and communicate meaning to the audience. • Design shows a perceptive understanding of its function and purpose within the performance. • Accomplished ability to develop a design that supports the creative intent of the performance as a whole. Design overall is dynamic and skilfully creates impact, showing full engagement and commitment to the performance.

Security and backups

It is the centre's responsibility to keep the work that students have submitted for assessment secure.

Secure storage is defined as a securely-locked cabinet or cupboard. Where students are producing artefacts, secure storage is defined as a classroom studio or workshop that is locked or supervised from the end of one session to the start of the next.

The rules on storage also apply to electronic data. For example, centres should collect memory sticks for secure storage between sessions or restrict student access to specific areas of the centre's IT network.

For materials stored electronically, centres are strongly advised to utilise firewall protection and virus-checking software, and to employ an effective backup strategy, so that an up-to-date archive of students' evidence is maintained.

Further information

For up-to-date advice on teacher involvement and administration of non-examination assessment, please refer to the Joint Council for Qualifications (JCQ) document *Instructions for conducting non-examination assessments (new GCE and GCSE specifications)* available on the JCQ website: www.jcq.org.uk